

# Erik T.J. Andersen

[www.erik-tj-andersen.com](http://www.erik-tj-andersen.com)

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## Contact Information

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## Education

2027 (Expected) Ph.D., Economics, University of Washington  
Fields: Development Economics, Economics of Education,  
Applied Microeconomics

2024 M.A., Economics, University of Washington

2022 M.S., Economics, University of Oregon

2021 B.S., Economics, University of Oregon  
Minor in Mathematics  
Summa Cum Laude, Phi Beta Kappa, Honors in Economics

## Working Papers

“How to Build a Reader: Evidence from a Scalable Literacy Intervention in Ghana” with Simon Graffy, Jason Kerwin, and Monica Lambon-Quayefio. February 2026 [[World Bank WPS11433](#)] [[Ungated Preprint](#)]

## Selected Work in Progress

When a Good School Isn't Enough: Evidence from Two Literacy Interventions in Ghana  
*Almost all evidence on education programs comes from settings where the counterfactual is business-as-usual schooling. As effective instruction scales, the policy question becomes what a program adds on top of it. I run a randomized trial in 103 Ghanaian schools already implementing an effective structured pedagogy program, testing two additional sources of learning: parents and principals. Schools received (i) restructured parent meetings plus take-home copies of the literacy workbook used in class, (ii) instructional leadership training for principals, (iii) both, or (iv) neither. The parent program raises reading fluency by 0.33 standard deviations, while the principal training lowers reading comprehension by 0.26 standard deviations. Combined, the parent program offsets part of the comprehension loss caused by the principal program. I show this is consistent with concave literacy production: the marginal return for parent engagement increases when instruction quality drops, so families invest more time in at-home learning.*

Is Awareness Always Good? An Accidental Information Intervention in Nigeria  
Cocoa no More: Evidence from Illegal Small-holder Gold Mining in Ghana

Why Cluster at all? Randomization Inference Correction to Incorrect Rejection Rates with Small Clusters

## **External Grants (\$855,101)**

- 2026 J-PAL Learning for All Initiative (LAI) – \$113,160  
“Government-Led Scaling of Tools for Foundational Learning Improvement (TFLI) in Ghana” (with Jason Kerwin, Simon Gaffy, Monica Lambon-Quayefio)
- 2026 J-PAL Learning for All Initiative (LAI) – \$34,040  
“Turning Parents into Learning Partners: Testing the Complementarity Between Home and School Investments in Ghana”
- 2025 CEGA Development Economics Challenge Grant – \$ 12,000  
“Turning Parents into Learning Partners: Testing the Complementarity Between Home and School Investments in Ghana”
- 2024 J-PAL Learning for All Initiative (LAI) – \$400,000  
“Integrating Educational Technology with Structured Pedagogy to Improve Learning Outcomes for Every Student” (with Jason Kerwin, Simon Gaffy, Monica Lambon-Quayefio)
- 2024 IPA Partnerships for Tech in Education (P4T-ed) – \$295,901  
“Integrating Educational Technology with Structured Pedagogy to Improve Learning Outcomes for Every Student” (with Jason Kerwin, Simon Gaffy, Monica Lambon-Quayefio)

## **Fellowships and Awards**

- 2026 Buechel Memorial Scholarship
- 2022 Provost Richards’ Fund for Graduate Students

## **Invited Presentations (Including Scheduled)**

- 2026 Comparative & International Education Society (CIES); Funds for Innovation in Development (FID); NBER Education Program Meeting (Presenter: Jason Kerwin); Ghana Education Evidence and Data Lab (GEEDLab)
- 2025 Inspiring Teachers; Gates Foundation Global Education; Prevail Fund; Sonoma State University

## **Invited Workshops (Including Scheduled)**

- 2026 Western Economic Association International’s Graduate Student Workshop

## **Consulting Positions**

- 2026 Research Consultant, Allan & Gill Gray Philanthropy Africa: Data-SMARTS

## Teaching

### **Instructor, Department of Economics, UW**

2025-            ECON 300: Intermediate Microeconomics  
2024-            ECON 200: Introduction to Microeconomics  
2024-            ECON 201: Introduction to Macroeconomics

### **Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, UW**

2023-2024      ECON 200: Introduction to Microeconomics  
2023-2026      ECON 201: Introduction to Macroeconomics

### **Teaching Assistant Coordinator, Department of Economics, UW**

2025-2026      ECON 200: Introduction to Microeconomics  
2025-2026      ECON 201: Introduction to Macroeconomics

## Professional Service

### **Journal Referee**

*Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*

### **Department Service**

2022-          Graduate Student Committee President

## Skills

Programming: R, SQL, Stata, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, Matlab, Mathematica, BASH

## References

### **Jason Kerwin (Chair)**

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University of Washington  
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### **Isabelle Cohen**

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University of Washington  
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### **Rachel Heath**

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University of Washington  
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